particular, a greater focus on technology and manufacturing is central to India's prospects. Digitization could well hold the key to the credible emergence of social welfare in a nation with stretched resources. Let us understand that in a world where trade wars and technology battles are likely to be more commonplace, de-industrialization is truly akin to unilateral disarmament. Therefore, making it easier to do business is not just an economic objective, it has enormous social and even strategic implications.

In the final analysis, it is central to the rapid strengthening of India's comprehensive national power. As far as reform is concerned, India would truly arrive when we internalize that this is an endless process with ever-widening application.

Challenges for national growth and development are not limited to socio-economic domains. Addressing governance deficits and implementation shortcomings are a major part of the solution. The problem, of course, comes in many forms and variations. They range from outdated policies and inadequate frameworks to casual implementation or even downright neglect. At the end of the day, it is as much about capabilities as it is about strategizing. If we bemoan the limitations of border infrastructure, we must ask ourselves the reasons for their current state. Quite apart from a deliberate neglect, the periphery will reflect in large measure the capabilities, or their limits, in the heartland. Leaving parts of the country underdeveloped or under-governed has its obvious risks, more so at the border. It also cannot be that we rise to special challenges, while neglecting the daily routine. Safeguarding borders, after all, is a 24x7 exercise, not only a crisis-driven response.

Our own debates in regard to national security need to recognize this value of putting in place the requisite structures and systems. Advocating sweeping solutions without laying the groundwork may be dramatic politics; it is not serious policy. On the contrary, our recent experience through the Gati Shakti initiative shows how much the national infrastructure can advance through stronger focus and integration. Breaking down silos and ensuring a more integrated governance process is just as important to national security. Underlying it is, of course, a basic willingness to fully recognize the challenges that the nation faces. By playing down issues like cross-border terrorism or competitive geopolitics,